

Prompt Like a Pro: Your AI Platform Comparison Guide

Not all AI tools are the same — and neither are the prompts that unlock them. Here's how to get genuinely useful output from the five platforms your business is most likely to use.

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WHY THIS GUIDE EXISTS

The Right Prompt Changes Everything

Every AI platform has a personality. ChatGPT thrives on conversation. Claude holds your brand voice. Gemini wants structure. Using the same prompt across all of them is like making the same small talk with your accountant, your best friend, and a job interviewer — it works, but it doesn't *work*.

This guide shows you the differences — practically, with real marketing examples — so you can stop guessing and start getting output worth using. No tech background needed.



5 platforms covered

ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Perplexity, and Canva AI — the tools small business owners are actually using.



Real prompt examples

Each platform includes a worked example with the actual prompt and what kind of output to expect.



Side-by-side comparison

One real marketing task, five platforms — so you can see the difference for yourself.

Platform Comparison

Platform	Best For	Prompt Style	Free Tier	Simplified AI Rating
 ChatGPT	First drafts, brainstorming, iteration	Conversational	YES	★★★★★
 Claude	Brand voice, long-form, nuanced content	Context-rich	YES	★★★★★
 Gemini	Research, planning, Google Workspace	Structured	YES	★★★★☆
 Perplexity	Fact-checking, sourced research, credibility	Research-style	YES	★★★★☆
 Canva AI	Quick copy tied to visual designs	Short & simple	LIMITED	★★★★☆☆

ChatGPT

GPT-4o · Available at chat.openai.com

ChatGPT is the most widely used AI tool — and for good reason. It's forgiving with prompts, quick to iterate, and handles almost any writing task you throw at it. It won't always nail your brand voice on the first try, but ask it for three versions and you'll have a solid starting point in under a minute.

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"Write 3 versions of an Instagram caption for a small business coach launching a new 6-week group program. Warm, encouraging tone. Keep each under 150 words."

WHAT TO EXPECT

Three distinct drafts, each with a slightly different angle — one more inspirational, one more direct, one more community-focused. The tone is usually solid, though it may lean a little generic without more brand context. These are great starting points to edit from, not finished copy.

1 Always ask for multiple versions

ChatGPT thrives on iteration. "Give me 3 options" or "write a short and a long version" gets you more useful output than a single draft.

2 Keep prompts simple to start

You don't need to over-engineer it. A clear, plain-language ask gets a strong first draft — then refine from there in the same chat window.

Claude

Anthropic · Available at claude.ai

Claude is where brand voice really shines. Give it context — who you are, what you sound like, what you don't want — and it will hold that through an entire piece of content. It's also excellent for longer-form writing: email sequences, blog posts, workshop descriptions. The more you brief it, the better it gets.

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"You are a content writer for a mindfulness coaching business. Our voice is warm, grounded, and evidence-informed — never hype, never clinical. Write an Instagram caption announcing a new 6-week mindfulness workshop. Include a gentle CTA. Under 150 words."

WHAT TO EXPECT

A noticeably more nuanced, on-voice result — especially if you've provided clear brand context. Claude naturally avoids hype language and defaulting to filler phrases. The output will feel considered rather than generated. Great for brands with a specific personality they need to protect.

1 Brief it like a new team member

Start with: "You are a content writer for [business name]. Our voice is [3 adjectives]. We never [thing to avoid]." Claude holds that context for the whole conversation.

2 Stack your requests

Claude handles complex, multi-part prompts well. Ask for a caption, a story script, and a hashtag set in one go — you'll get all three, coherently.

Gemini

Google · Available at gemini.google.com

Gemini is Google's AI — and it behaves like it. It responds especially well to structured, specific prompts, and it integrates directly into Google Docs and Sheets for a seamless workflow. Use it to build your content research base: topic lists, sourced statistics, or content calendars that live in your Drive.

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"List 5 evidence-based benefits of mindfulness for workplace stress. For each one, write a single LinkedIn-ready sentence I could use in a post. Cite a source for each claim."

WHAT TO EXPECT

Structured, well-organised output — numbered, sourced, formatted. The writing can feel slightly formal compared to ChatGPT or Claude, but the credibility layer is genuinely useful. Run this in Google Docs to edit the output directly without copy-pasting.

1 Specify your format upfront

Ask for "a numbered list", "a table with two columns", or "bullet points with bolded headings." Gemini is a strong formatter — tell it what shape you want.

2 Use it inside Google Docs

The "Help me write" button in Google Docs runs Gemini directly in your document. Great for drafting proposals, content briefs, or email sequences without leaving your workflow.

Perplexity

Perplexity AI • Available at perplexity.ai

Perplexity is an AI search engine — it browses the web in real time and returns cited sources with every answer. For any business in health, wellness, finance, or another credibility-sensitive field, this is your fact-checking partner before you post. Don't publish a claim you can't back up. Perplexity helps you find the backing.

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"What does recent research say about the link between mindfulness practice and reduced anxiety? Give me 3 specific findings, each with the source and year, that I could reference in a social media post."

WHAT TO EXPECT

Real-time, sourced results — with links to actual studies or reputable publications. This is not marketing copy; it's research infrastructure. Use what you find here to strengthen the claims in the copy you write elsewhere. Always check sources directly before publishing anything health-adjacent.

1 Use it before you write, not after

Perplexity builds your credibility foundation. Gather your supporting evidence first, then take those facts into ChatGPT or Claude to write the actual post.

2 Ask follow-up questions

Perplexity keeps full context across a conversation. Start broad ("what does research say about X?") then narrow: "What about specifically in small business owners?" or "Any Australian studies?"

Canva AI

Magic Write • Available inside Canva

Canva's Magic Write is built for one thing: getting words onto a design quickly. It's not a deep writing tool, but when you're already in Canva building a post and need a caption or headline, it's fast and surprisingly capable for short-form copy. Keep your prompts short, and it delivers.

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"Short Instagram caption for a mindfulness workshop. Warm and inviting. Maximum 3 sentences."

WHAT TO EXPECT

Brief, clean copy that fits naturally next to a visual design. It won't have much nuance or brand depth, but for a quick headline or two-sentence caption on a designed post, it does the job without breaking your workflow. Expect to edit the output lightly.

1 Shorter prompts, better output

Magic Write is optimised for speed, not depth. Keep prompts under 20 words. Anything longer tends to produce generic results.

2 Design first, then prompt

Use Magic Write after your visual concept is set — the design context naturally shapes what copy feels right. Starting with the design makes the writing ask clearer.

See the Difference

One real marketing task, run across all five platforms. Here's how each one handled it — and what that means for how you use them.

<> "Write an Instagram caption for a wellness coach announcing a new mindfulness workshop. Warm tone, include a gentle call to action."

ChatGPT

Clear structure, friendly tone, solid CTA. Can lean slightly generic without brand context — ask for 3 versions to find the best angle.

**BEST FOR:
FIRST DRAFT**

Claude

Noticeably warmer and more considered — especially when given brand context. Avoids hype language naturally. Feels written, not generated.

**BEST FOR:
ON-VOICE
COPY**

Gemini

Clean and structured, though slightly formal. A follow-up prompt ("warm the tone up") usually fixes it. Strong when you need a factual hook.

**BEST FOR:
INFORMED
DRAFTS**

Perplexity

Will attempt creative copy but isn't optimised for it. Better used to research what topics resonate before writing. Use it before, not instead of, a writing tool.

**BEST FOR:
PRE-WRITING
RESEARCH**

Canva AI

Short, visual-ready, adequate. Won't wow you, but if you're already in Canva and need 2–3 sentences fast, it earns its place.

**BEST FOR:
QUICK
DESIGN COPY**

WHERE TO START

Your Starter Stack

You don't need to master all five platforms at once. Here's a practical recommendation for most small business owners:

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| → Writing captions, emails & content: | Start with ChatGPT for fast drafts, switch to Claude when you need it to sound unmistakably like you. | → Research & fact-checking: | Use Perplexity before you write anything claim-heavy, especially in health, finance, or coaching. |
| → Planning & Google Workspace: | Gemini lives in your Docs already — use it for content briefs and structured planning. | → Quick design copy: | Canva AI is fine for headlines and short captions when you're already in the design tool. |

READY TO BUILD YOUR STACK?

Get in Touch

Tell us about your business — we'll help you figure out if Simplifai Stack is the right fit and where to start.

EMAIL THE SIMPLIFAI TEAM →

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We'll reply within 1 business day.